

FAB-250

The **FAB-250** is a Soviet-designed 250-kilogram (550 lb) general purpose air-dropped bomb with a high-explosive warhead, primarily used by the Russian Air Force, former Soviet republics and customer Countries. It is very widespread throughout the Third World and used in many conflicts in Asia and Africa among others. The original M-46 model was rolled out in 1946, followed by the M-54 model 1954 with reinforced structure, both models shaped for internal carriage by heavy bombers, a low-drag M-62 version in 1962 was intended for fighter bomber external hardpoint carriage.^{[4][2]} The bomb is unguided, features a single nose fuse, and is compatible with most models of Soviet aircraft.^[5] The FAB-250 was extensively employed over Afghanistan by Soviet and allied Afghan forces during the 1980s.^[6] The FAB-250 has been used most recently over Syria by both Russian and Syrian warplanes.^[7] Ethiopia used it during the Tigray War.

During the 2023 Russian invasion of Ukraine Russia adapted FAB-250 bombs and equipped them with planning and correction modules (UMPC) containing Inertial navigation system similar to the adaptations made to FAB-500 M-62 bombs, the FAB-250 M-62 is lighter and more aerodynamic than the heavier FAB-500 M-62, which means it is less destructive but has a longer gliding range which has been stated as 80 kilometres, this reduces the likelihood of Russian aircraft when deploying the adapted bombs of being hit by Ukrainian Surface-to-air missile systems.^[8]

According to the Institute for the Study of War a FAB-250: “ 250 kilograms, hold an explosive weight of 99 kilograms, have a damage radius of 120 meters, and can destroy manpower, equipment, and light fortifications.” ^[9]

Variants

- **FAB-250 M-46** - 1946 model, original high-drag model intended for internal carriage on heavy bombers, thin walls.
- **FAB-250 M-54** - 1954 model, improved high-drag model with reinforced structure.

FAB-250 M-62 General Purpose (GP) Bomb ^{[1][2][3]}	
	
FAB-250 M-62	
Type	High-drag and low-drag general-purpose bomb
Place of origin	<u>Soviet Union</u>
Production history	
Produced	1946–? (M-46) 1954–present; (M-54); 1962–present (M-62)
Variants	<u>KAB-250</u>
Specifications	
Mass	250 kilograms (551 lb)
Length	1.92 m
Diameter	0.3 m
Filling	High explosive
Filling weight	100 kg
Detonation mechanism	Impact fuse

- **FAB-250 M-62** - 1962 model, low-drag model designed for external carriage on hardpoints on fighter-bombers.^[10]

See also

- FAB-500
- Mark 82 bomb - American counterpart

References

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